

Impact High · Difficulty Easy-Medium · Misuse risk It fails when it becomes a tactic to soften a hidden ask, gets delivered mechanically

THE MOVE

Name the specific action -> name the positive effect -> keep it proportionate -> stop before it becomes flattery. -> "I appreciated how you grouped the actions; it saved everyone re-reading the thread." -> "Thanks for chasing the supplier twice..."

START HERE

Name one specific thing the person did and the effect it had, in a single plain sentence: "I appreciated X because it helped Y."

SAY THIS

Quick	<i>"That bit where you flagged the risk early was really helpful."</i>
Warm	<i>"I noticed how patiently you talked them through it, and it mattered."</i>
Professional	<i>"I appreciated how you grouped the actions; it saved everyone re-reading the thread."</i>
Naming the effect	<i>"Here's the concrete thing that helped: you made the next step clear."</i>
Digital / text	<i>"Just want to name it: the way you framed that message was spot on."</i>
Guarded / high-status	<i>"I'll keep this brief because I know you'd rather not make a thing of it: that was well judged."</i>

AVOID

- Praise would embarrass the person in public
- The appreciation is really there to soften a hidden ask
- You don't actually mean it

REMEMBER

Name the evidence.